Vasile Grafu

Engineering Manager | Solutions Architect | Software Architecture, Cloud & Agentic AI

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SUMMARY

21+ years in software development, and every phase of it: shaping the specification, designing the architecture, writing the code, holding the quality, shipping the release, and running it in production. Usually several of those at once.

- Millions of requests served every day by the platform my team runs
- 50 web services in production, distributed across AWS
- 9 years leading teams, five of them running two at once
- 10,000+ business clients on the systems I have built and led
- 21+ years, from real-time game engines to agentic AI systems

SKILLS

AI & Machine Learning: AI-Assisted Software Development, Agentic Architectures & LLM Orchestration, RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation), MCP Gateways, MCP Servers & tool integrations, Machine Learning, Neural Networks & Deep Learning Foundations

Backend & Architecture: C#, .NET, ASP.NET Core, Entity Framework, LINQ, Python, FastAPI, Flask, SQLAlchemy, Solution & Software Architecture, Framework Design, API Design (REST, SOAP/WCF)

Cloud, Data & DevOps: AWS (EC2, ECS, Fargate, RDS, S3, CloudFormation, CDK), Git, GitHub, GitHub Actions, Docker, CI/CD, End-to-end testing (pytest, Playwright), SQL Server, PostgreSQL, Database Design, Relational Databases

Leadership & Management: Engineering Management, Team & Technical Leadership, Hiring & Mentoring, Agile / Scrum, Project Management (Prince2), Strategic Planning

Frontend & Web: JavaScript, TypeScript, jQuery, ReactJS, Material UI, HTML, CSS, SASS, Astro, Tailwind CSS, HTMX, Server-Rendered Web (ASP.NET MVC + Razor, Flask + Jinja)

Foundations: Probability, Linear Algebra, Calculus, Statistics, Data Structures & Algorithms, Problem Solving & Analytical Thinking, Software Architecture Principles, Design Patterns & Clean Code

EXPERIENCE

January 2022 – Present · Bucharest, Romania

Engineering Manager · nShift (formerly Consignor)

COMPANY Global delivery-management platform — over 1,000 carriers across some 190 countries.

ROLE I lead the Webservices Team — one of the company's core teams — building applications that handle millions of requests per day and support multiple business-critical systems. Most weeks I wear several hats at once: software architect, software engineer, AI engineer and engineering manager. In practice that means owning the architecture, writing a large share of the code, building the AI systems on top of it, and still setting direction for the team.

- **Software architecture:** design and implementation of scalable, secure, and maintainable systems.
- **Software engineering:** shared components, application structure, data flow, database design, security, and infrastructure.
- **AI engineering:** the agentic systems built on top — LLMs, agent orchestration, RAG, and MCP servers and tool integrations.
- **Solution Architect:** cloud environments on AWS, and the CI/CD pipelines that deliver to them.
- **Test automation:** helped build the end-to-end test framework covering the APIs and the UI, and the tests that run on it.
- **Lead and manage the Webservices Team:** setting clear goals, providing direction, and keeping every member motivated and effective.

- **Establish engineering processes and standards:** consistent development practices that improve collaboration, maintain quality, and accelerate delivery.
- **Provide technical guidance:** solving complex issues alongside developers, reviewing designs, and making critical decisions on challenging topics.
- **Recruit and develop engineers:** active role in hiring, onboarding, and mentoring to build a skilled, cohesive team.
- **Act as Scrum Master:** stand-ups, planning, retrospectives, and effective communication between Product Owners and developers.

TECH C# / .NET, ASP.NET Core · Python, FastAPI, SQLAlchemy · SQL Server, PostgreSQL · JavaScript, TypeScript, ReactJS, Material UI · LLMs, Agents, RAG, MCP · AWS (EC2, ECS, Fargate, RDS, S3, CloudFormation, CDK) · Git, GitHub, GitHub Actions · Docker · pytest, Playwright · AI-assisted engineering

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January 2017 – January 2022 · Bucharest, Romania

Team Manager · Consignor (formerly Edisoft)

COMPANY Scandinavia's leading multi-carrier shipping software; 10,000+ business customers.

ROLE I led two teams — the Webservices Team and the Integration Team — and wore the hat each situation demanded: Team Manager, Technical Lead, Project Manager (Prince2), or Software Developer. In practice that meant hiring and training the people who joined, owning the critical architecture decisions, running projects across team boundaries — and still writing code myself. These years also spanned the 2021 merger with Unifaun and Transsmart that turned Consignor into nShift.

- **Webservices Team:** ran the web services serving the client components of the Consignor business.
- **Integration Team:** brought Consignor functionality to the major e-commerce and checkout platforms — WooCommerce, Magento and Klarna.
- **Software architecture:** the design decisions across the Consignor suite — service boundaries, shared components and the data model.
- **Software engineering:** shared components, application structure and database design across the suite, and the PHP integrations into the e-commerce platforms.
- **Solution Architect:** the AWS environments the platform ran on, from EC2 to Docker containers on ECS and Fargate, and the CI/CD pipelines that deployed to them.
- **Team leadership:** set goals and direction for both teams, keeping two groups with very different missions pulling toward one platform.
- **Technical guidance:** worked through the hard problems alongside the developers.
- **Recruit and develop engineers:** hiring, onboarding, and training the people who joined either team.

TECH C# / .NET, ASP.NET Core · PHP · AWS (EC2, ECS, Fargate, S3, CloudFormation) · Git, Bitbucket, GitLab · Docker · Project Management (Prince2)

2010 – 2017 · Bucharest, Romania

Technical Lead · Consignor (formerly Edisoft)

ROLE I led the Webservices Team, behind the 50 web services that served over 10,000 business clients in the Consignor application suite.

- **Applications at the core of the platform:** built Routing Codes, Address Lookup and Sending Edifacts — all still part of the nShift ecosystem today.
- **Custom Price Calculation Engine:** kept developing the engine I had built the year before, as its use spread across the platform.
- **Software architecture and solution design:** owned the design decisions across the Consignor suite, from service boundaries to data model.
- **Software engineering:** wrote a large share of the code myself, alongside the team rather than above it.
- **Mentoring:** brought on junior and senior developers, and helped hire the people who joined.

TECH C# / .NET, ASP.NET MVC, WCF · SQL Server · JavaScript, jQuery · AWS (EC2, S3) · SVN and Git (Bitbucket, GitLab)

2009 – 2010 · Bucharest, Romania

Senior Software Developer · Edisoft

COMPANY Later rebranded as Consignor; today part of nShift.

ROLE I designed and built the Custom Price Calculation Engine, and when the manager left the following year I took over the Webservices Team as Technical Lead.

- **Custom Price Calculation Engine:** designed and built it — customers upload the rates they have agreed with their carriers, the engine parses that price sheet, and it calculates the price of each shipment from it.
- **Still in production:** written in 2009 and running today across nShift, where thousands of customers depend on it.
- **Outgrew one developer:** the application became large enough to need its own team, first at Edisoft and later Consignor, building price sheets with customers and training them on it.

TECH C# / .NET, ASP.NET Web Forms, WCF · SQL Server · SVN

2008 – 2009 · Bucharest, Romania

Team Leader · TeamNet

COMPANY Romanian technology and systems-integration company.

ROLE The title here covered module ownership rather than people: I took Optimus ERP modules end to end, from specification through testing and deployment. Leading a team came later, at Consignor.

- **Optimus ERP modules:** managed them through every development step, from specification to testing and deployment.
- **Feature planning:** built development plans for new features with the design department.
- **Quality and maintenance:** enhanced existing features, and triaged and resolved every defect raised by the Quality Department.

TECH C# / .NET, WinForms · SQL Server

January 2005 – June 2008 · Bucharest, Romania

Game Programmer · Ubisoft

COMPANY One of the world's largest video game publishers.

ROLE I designed, developed, and optimized gameplay and platform modules on four shipped and in-development titles.

- **Silent Hunter 4:** designed and built the framework managing the evolution of the Crew, Weapons, and Equipment of the U-Boat simulator.
- **King Kong (PC):** Windows Media Center integration, multithreaded rendering, and the security module.
- **Blazing Angels (PC):** Save/Load system and Media Center shell implementation.
- **Tom Clancy's FireHawk:** ERS (Enhanced Reality System) module.

TECH C++, STL · Linear algebra, Calculus, Probability

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Computer Science, Specialization in Project Management — Academy of Economic Studies, Bucharest (2000 – 2002)

Bachelor in Business Administration, Major in Computer Science, Specialization in Computer Science Applied in Business — Academy of Economic Studies, Bucharest (1995 – 2000)